STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			I-5530
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED **04/16/24**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE INVESTIGATIONS: NARCOTICS K-9	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT NARCOTICS K-9 CARE AND EQUIPMENT		CROSS REFERENCE G-4200 PURCHASES		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the kenneling and care of Sheriff's Office canines and the maintenance of Narcotics K-9 equipment.

II. Policy:

Handlers shall be responsible for ensuring their assigned K-9s receive regular veterinary care, exercise and maintenance. The cost of all care and maintenance (e.g., food, supplements, medication, veterinary care, etc.) shall be the responsibility of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office. K-9 handlers shall be responsible for the maintenance of all assigned Narcotics K-9 equipment including K-9 patrol units.

III. Procedure:

A. Kenneling of Narcotics K-9s:

1. Each K-9 handler shall be issued an enclosed kennel to ensure the safe/secure kenneling of his or her assigned narcotics K-9 inside the handler's residence.

2. The narcotics unit K-9 will also be provided an additional kennel to ensure the safe/secure kenneling of his or her assigned narcotics K-9 inside any offsite space used by the Omaha Metro Drug Task Force.

3. Each K-9 handler shall also be issued an appropriate outdoor kennel to ensure the safe and secure kenneling of his or her assigned K-9 on the handler's property.

4. If a handler is on extended leave, the handler shall coordinate for kenneling, if needed. The K-9 may be allowed to remain at the handler's residence if

the handler can demonstrate full control over the K-9 during the entire period of absence.

5. Investigations command staff may make periodic inspections of each narcotics K-9 handler's residence and K-9 kenneling arrangements to ensure adequate care and safety.

B. **Routine Care of K-9s:** The K-9 handler is responsible for the care, cleaning, handling, and daily training of his or her assigned K-9.

1. K-9 handlers are personally responsible for the daily care and feeding to include:

a) Maintenance and cleaning of the kennel and area where the canine is housed.

b) Provision of food, water and general diet maintenance as prescribed by an authorized veterinarian.

c) Grooming on a daily basis or more often as required by weather or work conditions

d) Daily exercise.

2. To allow for required maintenance of the K-9 and equipment, thirty (30) minutes of each handler's shift shall be dedicated for this purpose.

3. Each K-9 handler shall be authorized thirty (30) minutes of overtime on any day not scheduled to work to provide daily maintenance for his or her assigned K-9.

C. **Veterinary Care for K-9s:** K-9s shall only be administered to by Sheriff's Office approved veterinarians, except in the case of emergency.

1. Each narcotics K-9 shall receive, at least, an annual physical including all vaccinations and a heartworm check.

2. The narcotics K-9 handler shall be responsible for coordinating all veterinary care for the narcotics K-9.

3. Narcotics K-9 handlers shall notify his or her supervisor of any emergency care required for an assigned narcotics K-9 or of any condition that may affect a narcotics K-9's ability to perform assigned duties.

D. Narcotics K-9 Equipment: Each narcotics K-9 handler shall be responsible for the care and maintenance of assigned equipment.

1. Equipment for the narcotics K-9 may differ from Road Patrol K-9 units based on daily duties. Generally, narcotics K-9 should reference the equipment used by K-9 units under the supervision of the K-9 Unit Commander as a guideline for their needs.

2. If the handler is required or authorized to purchase an item of equipment or item for his or her K-9's maintenance, the handler shall submit the request for reimbursement to the Investigations Division Command. Investigations Division Command shall review the request prior to submitting it according to established procedure (see G-4200 Purchases).

3. Narcotics K-9 handlers shall be responsible for reporting any damage to narcotics K-9 equipment to his or her supervisor as soon as possible.

E. Ownership of K-9s:

1. Upon purchase of any canine for the Sheriff's Office K-9 Unit, the animal shall become the property of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office.

2. If the K-9 is a registered purebred animal, registration papers and all other records shall be maintained by the K-9 handler.

3. Sheriff's Office K-9s shall not knowingly be used for breeding without the written permission of the Sheriff. Sheriff's Office K-9s shall not be used for participation in shows, field trials, exhibitions or other demonstrations without permission from Investigations Command.

4. When a K-9 is no longer capable of performing assigned duties as required, it shall be retired from duty.

a) Every attempt shall be made to transfer ownership of a retired K-9 to the handler, if he or she desires, or to another suitable owner.

b) A Release form shall be completed and signed by any party taking ownership of a retired K-9. Parties taking ownership of a retired K-9 accept all responsibility for the animal.

c) Certain stipulations regarding the transfer of ownership of a retired K-9 may need to be followed if the K-9 was purchased with funds other than those provided by Sarpy County.